TEAM KNOWLEDGE SESSION

CoCo for Business Analysts

Using Snowflake Cortex Code with our medallion data lake: a practical, no-code-required guide

October 2026

Snowsight · Desktop · Streamlit · Governance · Hands-on labs

WELCOME

What you will take away

Explain it

Say in two sentences what CoCo is, what it can do, and what it cannot do for you.

Use it

Open CoCo in Snowsight and write a first prompt that gets a useful answer.

Apply it

Run nine business-analyst playbooks against our medallion data lake.

Trust it wisely

Know the approval modes, verify results, and know when to ask for help.

WELCOME

Agenda

1. Welcome and mindset
2. What CoCo is and how it fits our data lake
3. Getting started and prompting
4. Nine playbooks for business analysts
5. Trust, safety and cost
6. Leveling up: skills, sharing, automation
7. Hands-on labs and our adoption plan

WELCOME

You are the SME. CoCo is the accelerator.

You bring

Business meaning, process knowledge, what a correct number looks like, and judgment on exceptions.

CoCo brings

Fast SQL drafts, table exploration, summaries, small apps, and patience for tedious steps.

CoCo drafts. You decide. Nothing leaves your hands unchecked.

UNDERSTAND

What is CoCo?

- **CoCo** is the nickname for **Cortex Code**, Snowflake's AI agent for working with data.
- You chat in plain English. It plans, writes SQL, runs it, reads the result and tries again.
- It works **inside our Snowflake**, under **your** role and permissions.
- It can **take actions** (run queries, create objects), so approvals matter.
- Three ways to use it: Snowsight, CoCo Desktop and the command line.

> **Think: a data-savvy assistant sitting next to you in Snowflake.**

UNDERSTAND

Three places to use CoCo

CoCo in Snowsight

A panel in the Snowflake web interface. No install. **Your home base as a BA.**

CoCo Desktop

A desktop app (macOS, Windows) with chat, SQL playground, charts, notebooks, dbt and app building.

CoCo CLI

A terminal tool called `cortex`. Used by developers and for automation.

Snowflake docs list all three as generally available; extras such as MCP, plugins and the Agent SDK are listed as preview.

UNDERSTAND

How CoCo works: an agent loop

Ask
You state the goal in plain English

→

Plan
CoCo proposes steps

→

Act
Runs SQL or tools, with your approval

→

Check
Shows results and assumptions

→

Refine
You adjust and repeat

You stay in the loop at Ask, Act (approval) and Check.

UNDERSTAND

CoCo runs as you

- It uses **your Snowflake role**. If you cannot see a table, neither can CoCo.
- Masking policies and row access policies still apply.
- Access needs a role such as **SNOWFLAKE.CORTEX_USER** (or CORTEX_AGENT_USER); Snowsight also needs **COPILOT_USER**.
- Admins also set a **daily credit limit** per user. Zero means blocked.
- Cross-region inference must be enabled for the account.

Cannot open CoCo? Ask your admin about the role and the daily limit.

UNDERSTAND

Our data lake: Medallion refresher

Bronze

Raw data exactly as landed from source systems.

→

Silver

Cleansed, conformed, de-duplicated business entities.

→

Gold

Business-ready, aggregated, reporting-friendly data.

- **Gold** for answers and reports. **Silver** to trace how a value was derived. **Bronze** to see what the source actually sent.

Layer and schema names in our Snowflake may differ; use your own naming.

UNDERSTAND

CoCo across the medallion layers

Layer	Good questions for CoCo	Watch out for
Bronze	What columns does this feed land? Show 10 sample rows.	Raw and possibly sensitive. Large tables cost more to scan.
Silver	What rules standardize member status? Which keys join these tables?	Transformation logic may be undocumented. Confirm with data engineering.
Gold	Monthly count of X by Y. Which tables feed this KPI?	Check that the definition matches the official KPI.

UNDERSTAND

Streamlit: small apps from a prompt

- **Streamlit** is a Python framework for simple interactive data apps.
- CoCo can generate one from a description: filters, tables, charts.
- Good uses: lookup tools, validation checkers, quick dashboards for the team.
- Treat every generated app as a **draft** until data owners and developers review it.
- Sharing an app shares data access: check who can open it.

> **Snowflake docs describe app building for Desktop and CLI. Confirm with the admin what is enabled in our Snowsight.**

GET STARTED

Opening CoCo in Snowsight

1. Sign in

Open Snowsight with your normal enterprise login.

2. Pick your role

Choose a role that has CoCo access.

3. Open the CoCo panel

Use the CoCo option in Snowsight. Placement can change between releases.

4. Set context

Choose a warehouse, database and schema to work in.

5. Type a request

Plain English. Start small.

6. Review and approve

Read what CoCo proposes before it runs.

GET STARTED

Four safe first prompts

```
What databases and schemas can I see? Summarize each in plain English.
```

```
Describe table <GOLD_TABLE>: columns, likely meaning of each, and 5 sample rows.
```

```
How many rows were loaded into <TABLE> each day over the last 30 days?
```

```
Explain this query in business terms:
<paste SQL here>
```

All four are read-only. Replace the bracketed names with your own objects.

GET STARTED

Give CoCo context

- Use the **full name** of objects: DATABASE.SCHEMA.TABLE.
- State the **business purpose**: who will use the answer and why.
- Paste the **rule or definition** you know to be correct.
- Say the **time window** and the **output shape** you want.
- Ask it to list **assumptions** and to show the SQL it ran.

> **Context you know is the context CoCo cannot guess.**

GET STARTED

The prompt recipe: G-D-R-O-C

STEP 1

Goal

The business question

STEP 2

Data

Which tables or layer

STEP 3

Rules

Definitions and filters

STEP 4

Output

Table, chart, mapping

STEP 5

Check

Assumptions and SQL

> **One sentence per step is enough.**

GET STARTED

Weak prompt vs strong prompt

Weak

```
Show me claims.
```

Strong

```
Goal: count paid claims by month for
last quarter.
Data: <GOLD.CLAIMS_FACT>.
Rules: exclude voided claims; use
service date.
Output: table by month and plan type.
Check: show SQL and list assumptions.
```

PLAYBOOK 1 OF 9

Find the right data

```
I need data about member enrollment
changes. Search the schemas I can access
and list candidate tables with a one-
line description, row count and last-
updated date. Rank by likelihood.
```

Use it when

You know the business concept but not the table name.

Check before you trust it

Confirm the table owner or steward. Prefer Gold unless you need detail.

PLAYBOOK 2 OF 9

Define a field in plain English

```
Explain column STATUS_CD in <TABLE>.
List distinct values with counts and
propose a plain-English meaning for
each. Mark any meaning that is a guess.
```

Use it when

A code column has unclear meaning.

Check before you trust it

Compare with the business glossary. Treat flagged guesses as questions for the owner.

PLAYBOOK 3 OF 9

Answer a question with SQL

```
How many active members by plan type at
the end of last quarter? Show the SQL,
your assumptions and the result table.
```

Use it when

A stakeholder asks for a number.

Check before you trust it

Read the filters and dates. Reconcile with a figure you already trust.

PLAYBOOK 4 OF 9

Data quality and reconciliation

```
Compare record counts and totals between
<SILVER_TABLE> and <GOLD_TABLE> by
month. List the differences and likely
causes.
```

Use it when

Numbers differ between two layers or reports.

Check before you trust it

Confirm causes with data engineering. Save the query for next time.

PLAYBOOK 5 OF 9

Source-to-target mapping

```
Create a source-to-target mapping for
<TARGET_TABLE> from <SOURCE_TABLES>:
target column, source column,
transformation, rule, notes. Mark
anything unknown.
```

Use it when

You need a mapping document for a target table.

Check before you trust it

Unknowns must be listed, not invented. Validate with the ETL or pipeline owners.

PLAYBOOK 6 OF 9

Impact analysis

```
If we rename or change the meaning of
column X in <TABLE>, which downstream
views and tables depend on it? List them
by layer.
```

Use it when

A column or table is about to change.

Check before you trust it

Results cover what Snowflake can see. Reports outside Snowflake may be missed, so confirm with owners.

PLAYBOOK 7 OF 9

Explain SQL in business language

```
Explain this SQL step by step for a
business audience. List the filters,
joins and business rules embedded in it.
<paste SQL>
```

Use it when

You inherit a query or view nobody documented.

Check before you trust it

Compare with documented rules. Ask the owner about any rule you did not expect.

PLAYBOOK 8 OF 9

Charts and small apps

```
Build a simple Streamlit app with
filters for month and plan type and a
bar chart of member counts from
<GOLD_TABLE>.
```

Use it when

You want a quick visual or a team lookup tool.

Check before you trust it

Chart row limits apply (Desktop visualization up to 500 rows). Get developer review before sharing.

PLAYBOOK 9 OF 9

Draft semantic definitions

```
Draft semantic definitions for
<GOLD_TABLES>: metrics (e.g. active
members), dimensions, synonyms and
standard filters, each with a plain-
English description.
```

Use it when

You want governed business metrics for natural-language questions.

Check before you trust it

Definitions are your domain. Get sign-off from data owners; developers deploy.

TRUST AND SAFETY

Seven golden rules

- Read the plan before you approve any action.
- Prefer read-only work; experiment in a sandbox schema.
- Follow data classification policy; confirm with Compliance before using PHI or PII.
- Verify numbers against a source you trust.
- Never approve deletes or writes you do not understand.
- Treat third-party skills and plugins as untrusted until reviewed.
- Save what works, and keep a human accountable for results.

TRUST AND SAFETY

Approval modes

Mode	What it does	Our advice
Confirm (CLI) / Default Approvals (Desktop)	Asks before each action.	**Use this.**
Plan (CLI)	Proposes a plan, makes no changes.	Great for learning and review.
Bypass (CLI and Desktop)	Runs without asking.	**Avoid** unless in a locked-down sandbox.

TRUST AND SAFETY

Guardrails admins can set

- **Restricted Session Scope:** narrows what a session may do. It can be switched to another scope but not removed within that session.
- **Managed settings and device management** let admins enforce organization policy.
- **Roles and policies** (masking, row access) always apply.
- **Daily credit limits and budgets** cap spend.

> **Ask the admin which guardrails are active for us.**

TRUST AND SAFETY

Know the risks

Plausible but wrong

Fluent answers can have wrong joins or filters. Snowflake-reported benchmark gains are vendor claims, not independent results.

Prompt injection

Hostile text in data, files or web pages can steer an agent. A flaw of this kind was reported and fixed in CLI 1.0.25.

Unvetted extensions

The Skill Catalog has no security scanning. Review before use.

Over-broad access

Your role is the limit. Ask for least privilege.

Cost surprises

Big scans and long sessions use credits.

Regulated data

HIPAA and data residency fit is not covered in the docs I reviewed. Ask Compliance.

TRUST AND SAFETY

Verification checklist

- Read the SQL: tables, joins, filters, dates.
- Do the row counts make sense? Compare with a known report.
- Test one edge case you know the answer to.
- Ask: "What assumptions did you make?"
- Ask for the same answer a different way and compare.
- Get a second pair of eyes before sharing outside the team.

> **If you cannot explain the number, do not send the number.**

TRUST AND SAFETY

Cost basics

- CoCo usage consumes **Snowflake credits**, and queries it runs use a **warehouse** too.
- Admins can set a **daily per-user limit** for each surface (-1 unlimited, 0 blocked) and budgets.

- Usage is visible in the usage history views and observability events.
- Save credits: be specific, sample before scanning, start a new chat for a new topic.

> **Ask the admin what our daily limit is and where usage reports live.**

LEVEL UP

Skills: recipe cards for CoCo

- A **skill** is a folder with a `SKILL.md` file of instructions CoCo follows when relevant.

- Captures **how our team does a task** so it is repeatable.
- BA examples: mapping template, reconciliation steps, glossary rules, requirement write-up.

- You can write one in plain Markdown. No code required.

LEVEL UP

Example: a mapping skill (illustrative)

```
---
name: source-to-target-mapping
description: Use when asked to draft a source-to-target mapping.
---
# Steps
1. Ask for the target table and source tables.
2. List columns: target, source, transformation, rule.
3. Mark anything unknown. Never invent rules.
4. Output as a table, then list open questions.
```

LEVEL UP

Standing instructions: AGENTS.md

- Instruction files give CoCo **standing context** for a project.
- Good for naming standards, layer conventions and safety rules.

```
# Team rules
- Prefer Gold tables; mention if Silver is used.
- Always show SQL and assumptions.
- Never run DELETE, DROP or UPDATE.
- Use sandbox schema ANALYST_SANDBOX for new objects.
```

LEVEL UP

Sharing skills and plugins

- The **Skill Catalog** lets teams share skills. It has **no security scanning**: review before use.

- **Plugins** bundle skills and tools. Plugin support is listed as preview.
- Agree on an owner, a review step and versioning for team-shared skills.
- Keep a short README: what the skill does, who approved it, when.

LEVEL UP

Automations: scheduled agent tasks

- Hosted automations run an agent task on a schedule (public preview).
- Minimum interval is hourly. Run history is kept for two months.
- They run with **no interactive approvals**, so keep them read-only.
- BA ideas: weekly data-quality summary, new-table alerts.

> **Involve a developer and your admin before scheduling anything.**

LEVEL UP

Working with developers

You deliver

Requirements, a mapping table, validated SQL draft, acceptance test queries, open questions.

Developers deliver

Production code, tests, deployment, access setup, monitoring.

Together

A shared review: CoCo draft, BA check of business logic, developer check of design.

PRACTICE

Lab 1: Explore (20 minutes)

- Open CoCo in Snowsight with your role.
- Run the four safe first prompts on a table you know well.
- Ask CoCo to describe the table and propose meanings for three columns.
- Mark which answers were right, wrong or unclear.

PRACTICE

Lab 2: Answer and verify (30 minutes)

- Pick a question you answered recently for a stakeholder.
- Write it with the G-D-R-O-C recipe.
- Compare CoCo's number with your known answer.
- If different, find out why: filters, dates or definitions?

PRACTICE

Lab 3: Draft a mapping or app (30 minutes)

- Choose a small target table you understand.
- Ask CoCo for a source-to-target mapping with unknowns marked.
- Review each row; correct the business rules.
- Optional: ask for a simple filter-and-chart app.

PRACTICE

30-60-90 day adoption plan

First 30 days: Learn

Everyone completes the three labs and uses read-only prompts in Snowsight.

Days 31 to 60: Apply

Use CoCo on live tasks: mappings, reconciliations, field definitions. Share what works.

Days 61 to 90: Scale

Create and review two team skills, agree standards, and report time saved.

PRACTICE

Team agreements (proposal)

- Default approvals always; no Bypass.
- Read-only unless a task needs otherwise and the owner agrees.
- Every number gets a verification step before it is shared.
- Skills are reviewed by a second person before team use.
- Regulated data only as permitted by Compliance.

PRACTICE

Seven things to remember

- CoCo is an agent that acts under **your** permissions.
- Start in Snowsight with read-only prompts.
- Give context with Goal, Data, Rules, Output, Check.
- Always read the SQL and the assumptions.
- Keep default approvals on.
- Share reviewed skills, not secrets.
- You are the SME. CoCo drafts; you decide.

PRACTICE

Confirm with admins and Compliance

- Which CoCo surfaces and features are enabled for us (Snowsight, Desktop, Streamlit)?
- Our roles, daily credit limits and budgets.
- Which Restricted Session Scope and managed settings apply.
- Whether PHI or PII may be used with CoCo, including HIPAA, BAA and data residency.
- Where to find usage reports and who owns the skill library.

PRACTICE

Resources

- Snowflake docs: docs.snowflake.com/en/user-guide/cortex-code/cortex-code
- Team materials: CoCo Complete Learning Guide (with Bibliography) and the 4-page Cheat Sheet.

- Third-party analyses and security write-ups are listed in the guide's Bibliography.
- YouTube videos are listed in the guide but **not reviewed**; watch with caution.

Product facts are from public documentation as of early October 2026 and may change.

Questions?

Your expertise + CoCo = faster, better-checked answers.

Let us start with Lab 1.